two. Daniella is struggling with the fever and needs to sleep. I say I'll take the girls in the adjoining room. It's one of those summer nights in London where everything sticks to you and the heat hangs around; off the houses, through the smoke and the lights, fertile conditions for flu as it commutes its way around the capital. I'm holding Ruby as we try to go to sleep, Lola in the bed next to mine, rolling around, restless. I can't get the temperature right in the room. Is the air conditioning on too high? Is it on at all? Am I feeling sick too? Ruby feels like she is slightly hot and I prop her up on my chest as I lie on the bed, checking on Lola next to me every five minutes, twitching, watching the clock, getting back up to check the air conditioning, to bob Ruby up and down to see if it helps her sleep, before getting back on to the bed, staring into the distance, hoping we can all sleep at some point soon.

My kitbag and whites and England gear are strewn all over the floor, just by the entrance to the adjoining door, barricading the room between mine and Daniella's. I am only thinking of the girls, working out ways to get them more comfortable and to help them sleep, but as the middle of the night draws in and the outside falls quieter, now just the sound of occasional cars going through Regent's Park, little flickers of the nightlife, the gear starts to scare me. What if I can't sleep? What if morning comes around and I haven't slept and I need to bowl India out? The more I think about it, the less I can sleep, and the less likely it is Ruby and Lola will. The three of us just sit it out, watching night set in and then brutal daylight come back, none of us having even managed a moment's sleep.

When we get to Lord's, I am panicking internally. The disorientation of a sleepless night is making even the most basic things – getting on to the team bus, arriving at the ground, going through the preparations – feel like a kind of hellish nightmare. An hour before play, I am still thinking to myself, maybe there's somewhere I can get just ten minutes? Maybe that would help? There is nowhere though, with Lord's alive with the possibility of another Test win, the dressing room populated by all the players I now know so well, the team from last year pretty much entirely still intact, all going through their processes. I say nothing to anyone, I just sit there staring into the fuzz of whites being thrown around and players doing stretches and people shouting different things at each other, thinking about